

How We Hear

The world is full of noise. It travels as sound waves through the air until it reaches our ears. There, they are turned into electrical impulses and sent to the brain for decoding into meaningful sounds.

Picking up sound

Hearing involves the conversion of a sound wave into an electrical impulse that the brain can interpret. Sound waves are carried from the outer to the middle ear, where they cause a series of bones and membranes to vibrate. These vibrations then reach the cochlea, where they become electrical impulses. These are passed to the brain stem and thalamus, where direction, frequency, and intensity are perceived. The data is then sent for processing by the left and right sides of the auditory cortex. The left side identifies the sound and gives it meaning, while the right side assesses the quality of the sound.

